

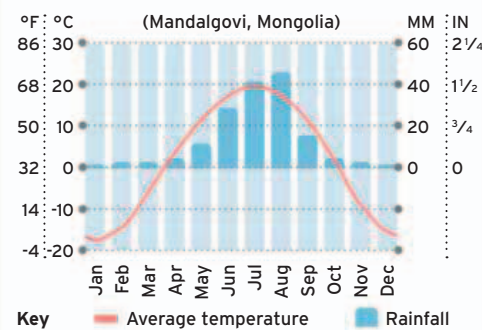
LOCATION

Lying in northern China and southern Mongolia, the Gobi is bordered by the Tibetan Plateau to the southwest.



CLIMATE

The Gobi is a cold, dry desert, and temperatures fluctuate wildly on both a daily and a seasonal basis.



Gobi bear

Ursus arctos gobiensis

limbs longer
than grizzly's



Smaller and lighter than other brown bears, Gobi bears have short, golden coats and proportionally longer limbs. They mainly eat plants, such as wild rhubarb, roots, and berries. The species is threatened by droughts, climate change, habitat destruction, and cubs being killed by wolves—fewer than 30 Gobi bears are thought to survive today.

GENETIC MYSTERY

DNA hair analysis indicates that Gobi bears are related to but distinct from other brown bears. No other brown bear could survive the Gobi Desert's harsh environment.

- ↔ 5–7 ft (1.5–2.1m)
- ⚖ 110–350 lb (50–160 kg)
- ⊗ Critically endangered
- 🏠 Plants, rodents, insects



C. Asia



Yarkand gazelle

Gazella yarkandensis

This antelope is one of three “goitered” species, named after the way males develop a swollen larynx for making loud bellows in the breeding season. Female Yarkand gazelles have tiny horns compared to males.

RACING AHEAD

Unlike other gazelles, this species does not use a prancing running style to confuse chasing predators. It escapes threats with a flat-out sprint.

- ↔ 3–4 ft (0.9–1.2m)
- ⚖ 44–66 lb (20–30 kg)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🌿 Grasses, leaves, herbs



C. Asia



BIG EARS

The tiny long-eared jerboa has one of the largest ear-to-body ratios of any mammal. It spends the day in tunnels, emerging at night to hunt insects. Small hairs on its feet help it move on sand, hopping like a kangaroo.

LONG-EARED JERBOA

